

M1 & M3 — Train Accidents, Incidents Floods, Snow & Emergencies

Driver Revision Guide

GERT8000-M1 Iss 9 (June 2026) | GERT8000-M3 Iss 5 (Dec 2025)

MODULE M1 — Train Accidents & Evacuation

Source: GERT8000-M1 Iss 9, June 2026

1. What Counts as a Train Accident?

A train accident (for the purposes of M1) includes:

- A derailment
- A collision involving trains or rail vehicles
- A collision with an obstruction
- A collision with a road vehicle
- A collision with a person
- A fire on a train that might put other trains in danger or require passenger evacuation onto running lines
- An accidental train division that has caused another line to be obstructed

M1 §1

2. Driver's Immediate Actions After a Train Accident

Step 1 — Hazard Warning

Immediately switch on the **hazard warning indication** where provided. If you cannot, display a **red light forward**.

M1 §2.1

Step 2 — Contact the Signaller

Tell the signaller about the accident and whether traction current needs to be switched off. Use the following order of preference:

- Make a **Railway Emergency Call (REC)** from your driving cab
- Any other direct communication available from the driving cab if REC is not possible
- Make a REC from any other driving cab on the train

If you have to leave your cab to make a REC from another cab, place a **track-circuit operating clip (TCOC)** on any other line that might be obstructed first.

M1 §2.1

Step 3 — Stay in the Cab

Once you have made contact with the signaller, stay in the cab until the signaller confirms **one** of the following:

- Every driver whose train must remain at a stand has received and understood the message

- No train is approaching

Step 4 — Report Obstructed Lines

Check whether any other lines are obstructed (if in doubt, treat them as obstructed). Tell the signaller which lines are obstructed. Place a TCOC on any other obstructed line if the signaller tells you to.

M1 §2.1

CRITICAL — If Signaller Says a Train is Approaching

Leave your train immediately and proceed TOWARDS the approaching train, showing a HAND DANGER SIGNAL.

3. Structure of an Emergency Call (REC)

Always state in this order:

- "This is an emergency call"
- Who you are and your train reporting number
- Where you are speaking from
- What has happened
- The exact location of the train accident
- Which lines are obstructed
- Whether the traction current needs to be switched off
- Whether the emergency services are needed

EMR PPT 26-03

4. If You Cannot Contact the Signaller from the Train

You must leave the train to tell the signaller. Before leaving:

- Find out which lines are obstructed (if in doubt, treat them as obstructed)
- Place a TCOC on each obstructed line
- Tell the guard (if provided) that you are leaving the train

Direction to proceed: Go towards the line that is more likely to have an approaching train, or where you are more likely to reach the signaller quickly. Show a **hand danger signal** visible to any approaching driver.

Contact the signaller via: any direct communication available from outside the train → any lineside telephone → going to the signal box.

M1 §2.1

5. Actions After Leaving the Train (4 T's and an S)

If certain situations arise before reaching the full protection distance, place **3 detonators 20 metres apart** and show a hand danger signal:

4 T's and an S — Place 3 Detonators When You Reach:

T — Train approaches

T — Tunnel entrance
T — Trailing/diverging junction
T — Telephone or lineside phone
S — Signal box (Absolute Block type)

At a Tunnel

Place 3 detonators at the tunnel entrance. Proceed through the tunnel only if: it is short, you believe communication is available just beyond, you can walk safely, and you can show a hand danger signal to any approaching train. Otherwise: stay at the entrance showing a hand danger signal.

M1 §3

At a Diverging Junction

Place 3 detonators 20 metres apart at the junction, stay at the junction, and show a hand danger signal to any approaching train.

M1 §3

If You Stop an Approaching Train

Tell the driver what has happened, and ask them to tell the signaller (if possible by making a REC).

M1 §3

6. Fire on a Train

Driver's Mnemonic — DROP, STOP, BOX

DROP → STOP → BOX

DROP — Drop the pantograph / shut down diesel (unless needed for safety) / switch off ETS

STOP — Stop in a suitable location (not a tunnel, viaduct, or other unsuitable place)

BOX — Contact the signaller (REC using Emergency Call button as first preference)

Stopping the Train

Try to put out any fire. However, if it cannot be put out **within a few seconds**, stop the train immediately. Where possible, avoid stopping in a tunnel, on a viaduct, or any other unsuitable place.

M1 §4.1

Safety of Passengers

Tell passengers to move to vehicles not affected by the fire. If passengers have to leave the train, carry out an evacuation.

M1 §4.2

Separating Burning Vehicles

If there is a risk of fire spreading and it can be done safely, separate the burning vehicles from the rest of the train.

M1 §4.3

If the Train Cannot Proceed After the Fire is Out

Tell the signaller. Carry out any necessary protection. If passengers are left on the train and safe, carry out a controlled evacuation when possible. Ensure any passengers who have left the train are in a safe position away from electrified lines and other running lines — keep them there until arrangements are made to escort them from the site.

M1 §4.4

If the Train Can Proceed After the Fire is Out

Tell the signaller as soon as possible.

M1 §4.5

Fire Extinguisher Classes (from PPT)

Know which extinguisher to use:

- **Class A** (cloth, wood, paper) — water or spray foam
- **Class B** (flammable liquids — oils, spirits, petrol) — foam, spray foam, or dry powder
- **Class C** (flammable gases — propane, butane) — dry powder
- **Electrical** — isolate power first; use CO2 or dry powder if power cannot be isolated

EMR PPT 25-03

7. Accidental Train Division

Driver's Actions

- Make sure both portions of the train are secure and all vehicles are accounted for
- Tell the guard (if provided) about the situation
- Check the couplings where the train divided — look for track/lineside damage and whether recoupling is possible

M1 §5.2a

If the Two Portions Can Be Recoupled

Get the **personal authority of the signaller** for the movement. Once recoupled, tell the signaller the train is again complete (stop specially if necessary).

M1 §5.3

If the Two Portions Cannot Be Recoupled

Before leaving the rear portion behind you must ensure:

- A **red light** is displayed at the rear of the portion being left behind
- A **white light** is displayed at the front of the portion being left behind

Then tell the signaller: that the rear portion is to be left in the section, and its exact location. Do not pass the next stop signal or block marker until you have told the signaller. Do not leave a single-line section until you have told the signaller.

Fit a tail lamp on the rear of the front portion on a track circuit block line. On other lines, fit it when the front portion reaches the next signal box or a track circuit block line.

M1 §5.4

Assisting Train — Driver's Role

When acting as the assisting train, the signaller will tell you the exact location of the divided portion and the colour of the light displayed on it.

CRITICAL — Assisting Train Speed Limit

Proceed at CAUTION. Do not exceed 25 mph (40 km/h).

M1 §5.5

8. Evacuating a Train

Only carry out a train evacuation if it is **absolutely necessary**.

M1 §6.1

Controlled Evacuation

Tell the signaller that the train is to be evacuated and ask them to stop any approaching trains on any affected line. If necessary, ask for traction current to be switched off. Wait until the signaller confirms no train is approaching, then tell the guard.

M1 §6.3

Emergency Evacuation

Carry out your Section 2.1 actions (contact signaller, check lines). Tell the signaller an emergency evacuation is taking place. If necessary, ask for traction current to be switched off. If the signaller says a train is approaching, proceed on foot towards it showing a hand danger signal.

M1 §6.4

Uncontrolled Evacuation

Carry out your Section 2.1 actions and tell the signaller an uncontrolled evacuation is taking place. If necessary, ask for traction current to be switched off. Try to prevent passengers making an uncontrolled evacuation and warn any who have evacuated about the risks.

M1 §6.6

CRITICAL — Before ANY Evacuation

Lines **MUST** be blocked and protected first. **BEFORE** any evacuation, ensure the signaller has stopped trains on all lines that may be affected.

M1 Quick Q&A

Q: What is the first thing you must do after a train accident?

Switch on the hazard warning indication where provided. If you cannot, display a red light forward. (M1 §2.1)

Q: In what order do you contact the signaller after an accident?

1. REC from your cab. 2. Any other direct communication from the cab. 3. REC from another cab on the train. (M1 §2.1)

Q: What do you do if the signaller tells you a train is approaching after an accident?

Leave your train immediately and proceed towards the approaching train showing a hand danger signal. (M1 §2.1)

Q: What three things must you remember if leaving the train to contact the signaller?

1. Find out which lines are obstructed (treat as obstructed if in doubt). 2. Place a TCOC on each obstructed line. 3. Tell the guard you are leaving. (M1 §2.1)

Q: What is the mnemonic for when to place 3 detonators before reaching full protection distance?

4 T's and an S: Train approaches, Tunnel, Trailing junction, Telephone, Signal box (Absolute Block). (EMR PPT 26-03)

Q: What is the speed limit for the assisting train when removing the rear portion of a divided train?

25 mph (40 km/h). Proceed at caution. (M1 §5.5)

Q: What lights must be displayed on a divided train portion left in section?

Red light at the rear of the portion left behind. White light at the front of the portion left behind. (M1 §5.4)

Q: When must you carry out an evacuation?

Only if it is absolutely necessary. Lines must be blocked and protected first. (M1 §6.1)

MODULE M3 — Managing Incidents, Floods & Snow

Source: GERT8000-M3 Iss 5, December 2025

1. Preserving Evidence After a Serious Accident

Emergency action always takes priority over preserving evidence. As a driver, your priorities in order are:

- Secure the train
- Protect the line
- Get traction current switched off
- Call the emergency services
- Make sure the public and other personnel are safe

M3 §1.1

Leaving Evidence Undisturbed

Do not disturb or interfere with evidence of the cause of a serious accident unless told to by: a Rail Incident Officer (RIO), a police incident officer, a RAIB investigator, or any other senior investigator. Immediately make a note of evidence that might be lost over time — such as wheel-tyre and brake-block temperatures and brake-gauge readings.

M3 §1.2

Entering a Driving Cab After an Accident

Only enter a driving cab if you have to:

- Secure the train
- Carry out rescue operations
- Use the cab radio to contact emergency services or the signaller
- Get equipment to protect the line or extinguish a fire
- Make a note of short-life evidence

If you enter the cab, be careful not to disturb equipment, handles, buttons or switches unnecessarily. Afterwards, make a detailed note of the original position of equipment and gauges, and give this to an investigating officer before you leave the scene.

M3 §1.3

Locking Cab Doors

Arrange to prevent unauthorised entry to the driving cab. If possible, lock the door to that cab and make sure other driving cab doors are also locked.

M3 §1.4

2. Derailments and Collisions

Derailments

Any vehicle that has been derailed must not be allowed to continue in service until examined by a rolling stock technician. Exception: if the derailment was at slow speed, vehicles that were not derailed or coupled next to a derailed vehicle may be examined at the first suitable location.

M3 §2.1

Collisions or Heavy Impacts

Any vehicle that has suffered a collision or heavy impact must not continue in service until examined by a rolling stock technician.

M3 §2.2

Collision With an Obstruction on the Line

Bring your train to a stand and check for damage that might affect safe movement. Speak to your TOC's control if any of the following may have been damaged:

- Brake equipment
- Coupling and drawgear
- Vehicle suspension
- Wheelsets
- Current collection equipment
- Lifeguards

Also speak to TOC control if you think damage may have increased the width or height of the train. Control will tell you whether the train is fit to proceed, and any speed restrictions. Being told the train is fit to continue **does not give you permission to proceed** — you must tell the signaller, who will confirm.

CRITICAL — Do Not Proceed Without Signaller Permission

Even after TOC control says the train is fit to continue, you must NOT proceed until the signaller gives you permission.

M3 §2.3a

Detaching and Moving a Damaged Vehicle

If part of a vehicle has become loose and cannot be secured, arrange for it to be cleared at the first suitable location. Before moving it: get the signaller's permission, get authority from a rolling stock technician if unsure, and move passengers from the vehicle if possible.

CRITICAL — Damaged Vehicle Speed Limits

Do not exceed 10 mph (15 km/h), or 5 mph (10 km/h) over points and crossings.

M3 §2.3b

3. Flood Water

Driver's Reporting Duty

Report to the signaller (stop specially if necessary) if you see flood water that might affect the passage of trains. Tell the signaller which applies:

- Water is up to the bottom of the rail head
- Water is up to the top of the rail head
- Water is above the top of the rail head
- Water is moving and likely to dislodge the ballast
- Ballast has already been dislodged

Also arrange for TOC control to be told if vehicles are stabled in or pass through flood water that is **above the bottom of the axle box**.

M3 §4.1

Flood Water — Signaller's Train Running Decisions (for context)

Up to bottom of rail head → normal running allowed

Up to top of rail head → maximum 5 mph (10 km/h)

Above top of rail head → suspend normal running, await Operations Control instructions

Moving water likely to dislodge ballast → suspend normal running regardless of depth

M3 §4.2

Reporting Flowing or Pooling Water

Immediately tell the signaller (stop specially if necessary) if you see any of the following that might affect structures or earthworks:

- Water rising up from the track or the cess

- Unusual amounts of water pooling next to the track or in the cess
- Water flowing down or pouring out of embankments or cuttings

Give the signaller the exact location, details, and whether the water is displacing any material.

M3 §4.3

4. Snow

Driver's Reporting Duty

Report to the signaller (stop specially if necessary) if you see any build-up of snow that might affect the passage of trains. In particular, report if you believe snow is deeper than **200 mm (8 inches) above the top of the rail head**.

M3 §5.1

Snow — Signaller's Decision (for context)

Normal running unless snow is deeper than 200 mm (8 inches) above the top of the rail head. If reported deeper than 200 mm → suspend normal running and await Operations Control instructions.

M3 §5.2

5. Damage to Structures or Earthworks

Driver's Reporting Duty

Immediately tell the signaller (stop specially if necessary) if you see any damage to structures or earthworks above or below the line. This includes:

- Landslips
- Washouts
- Embankment failures
- Retaining wall failures

Give the exact location, details, and which lines are affected.

M3 §7.1

Extreme Weather — Blanket Speed Restriction

If Operations Control has told the signaller about extreme weather, the signaller may impose a blanket speed restriction. This can be communicated to you via a GSM-R broadcast message — you **do not have to acknowledge** this message.

M3 §7.3

6. What Must You Report and When?

You must stop your train specially to report (where necessary) the following:

What you see	Rule Book ref	Key threshold
Flood water on track	<i>M3 §4.1</i>	Any level up to/above rail head
Flowing/pooling water	<i>M3 §4.3</i>	Any that might affect

		structures/earthworks
Snow build-up	<i>M3 §5.1</i>	>200 mm (8 inches) above top of rail head
Structural/earthwork damage	<i>M3 §7.1</i>	Any landslip, washout, embankment or wall failure
Train accident or obstruction	<i>M1 §2.1</i>	Immediately — via REC where possible

M3 Quick Q&A

Q: What are your five priorities after a serious accident?

1. Secure the train. 2. Protect the line. 3. Get traction current switched off. 4. Call emergency services. 5. Ensure public and personnel are safe. (M3 §1.1)

Q: When can you enter a driving cab after an accident?

Only to: secure the train; carry out rescue; use cab radio for emergency services/signaller; get protection equipment; note short-life evidence. Be careful not to disturb anything unnecessarily. (M3 §1.3)

Q: After a collision with an obstruction, being told by TOC control that the train is fit to proceed — can you move?

No. This is NOT permission to proceed. You must tell the signaller what control said, and wait for the signaller to give you permission to proceed. (M3 §2.3a)

Q: What is the speed limit when moving a damaged vehicle with a loose component?

10 mph (15 km/h) maximum; 5 mph (10 km/h) over points and crossings. (M3 §2.3b)

Q: At what flood water level must a driver report to the signaller?

Any flood water that might affect the passage of trains — report the level (bottom of rail head, top of rail head, above top of rail head, moving, or ballast dislodged). (M3 §4.1)

Q: At what snow depth must you report to the signaller?

If you believe snow is deeper than 200 mm (8 inches) above the top of the rail head. (M3 §5.1)

Q: What must you report immediately if you see water rising up from the track or cess?

Tell the signaller immediately (stop specially if necessary). Give exact location, details, and whether material is being displaced. (M3 §4.3)

Q: Do you need to acknowledge a GSM-R blanket speed restriction broadcast from a

signaller?

No. You do not have to acknowledge the message. (M3 §7.3)

7. Driver's Incident Report

You may need to complete a driver's report form before booking off duty after:

- Any operational incident or accident
- To explain an operating problem or your actions
- To explain late running of your train
- After witnessing an incident, accident, or incorrect working practices
- When requested to do so by your line manager

Tip: Make notes in a notebook or on your schedule card/diagram immediately — this makes completing the report form more accurate.

EMR PPT 25-01

Key Critical Rules at a Glance

M1 — After a Train Accident

1. Hazard warning on (or red light forward)
2. REC to signaller — tell them what happened and whether traction current needs off
3. Place TCOC on any obstructed line if signaller tells you to
4. Stay in cab until signaller confirms protection provided or no train approaching
5. If a train IS approaching — leave train and walk TOWARDS it with hand danger signal

M1 — Fire on a Train

DROP (pantograph/diesel/ETS) → STOP (suitable location, not tunnel or viaduct) → BOX (contact signaller via REC)
Lines must be blocked and protected BEFORE evacuating passengers

M1 — Divided Train (Cannot Recouple)

Red light at rear of portion left behind
White light at front of portion left behind
Tell signaller exact location before passing next stop signal
Assisting train: max 25 mph, proceed at caution

M3 — After a Collision with an Obstruction

Stop and check for damage
Call TOC control if any key components may be damaged
TOC control saying "fit to proceed" is NOT permission to move
Must get signaller's permission before proceeding

M3 — Environmental Reporting Thresholds

Flood water: Report any level that might affect passage of trains

Snow: Report if deeper than 200 mm (8 inches) above rail head

Structures/earthworks damage: Report any damage immediately